Weeder



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Hand weeder; Manual weeder

What it is used for

To remove weeds and loosen soil around plants using a manual weeder. To control unwanted growth while minimizing damage to crop roots and nearby plants.

Main parts

- Handle
- Working blade or fork
- Neck or shaft
- Grip, if fitted

Before you start

1. Choose a weeder suitable for the soil and weed type.
2. Inspect the handle and working end for cracks or looseness.
3. Wear suitable gloves and closed footwear.
4. Check the work area for buried cables, pipes, or sharp debris.

How to use

1. Identify the weed and the area around its roots.
2. Hold the handle securely and position the working end near the weed.
3. Insert the blade or fork into the soil with controlled pressure.
4. Loosen the soil and lift the weed, aiming to remove its roots where practical.
5. Avoid damaging nearby plant roots.
6. Collect the removed weeds and dispose of them appropriately.
7. Clean the tool after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep hands and feet clear of the working end.
- Do not dig near suspected underground utilities.
- Use the tool only for its intended purpose.
- Maintain stable footing on uneven ground.

Care & storage

- Remove soil and plant residue after use.
- Dry metal parts to reduce rust.

- Inspect the handle and working end regularly.
- Store in a dry location.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using excessive force in compacted soil.
- Cutting nearby crop roots while removing weeds.
- Leaving weed seeds or roots where they can regrow.
- Using a loose or damaged handle.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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